Life Cycle of and Open Access to Research Data in Finland

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Finnish Social Science Data Archive (FSD)

IASSIST 2008
Stanford, California, USA

Presentation

- FSD?
- OECD Principles
- Current situation in Finnish universities
  - Data preservation
  - Data reuse
- Attitudes towards Open Access to Data
- Future prospects of data OA

Finnish Social Science Data Archive at a glance (FSD)

- Acquires, processes, preserves and disseminates digital data
- National resource
- Services for research and teaching
- Nearly 800 quantitative data sets, 70 qualitative data sets
- Hosts IASSIST 2009

OECD Principles for Access to Research Data from Public Funding

- Openness of science
- Diversity of opinion
- New research
- New or alternative hypothesis and analysis methods
- New topics (when reusing data)
- Education of new researchers

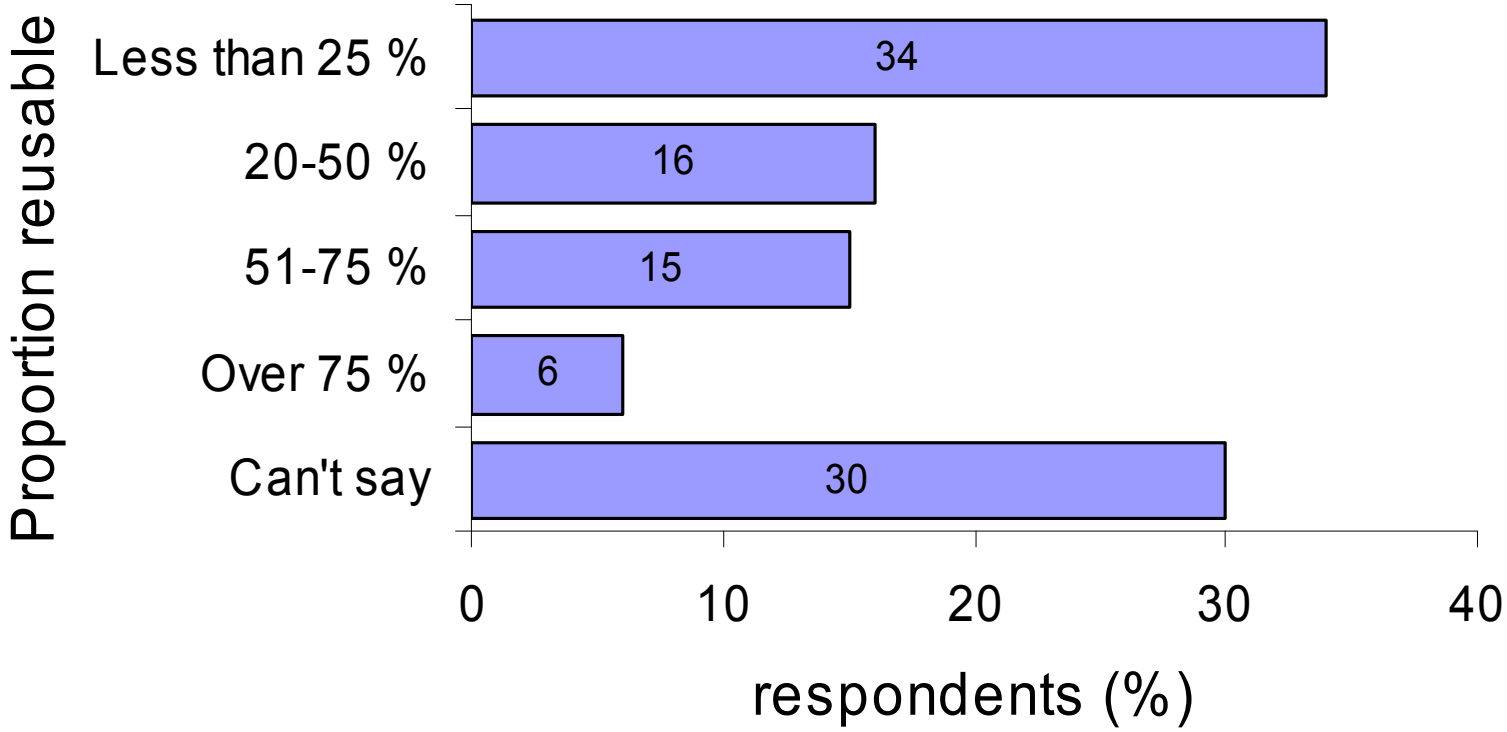
Survey carried out by FSD

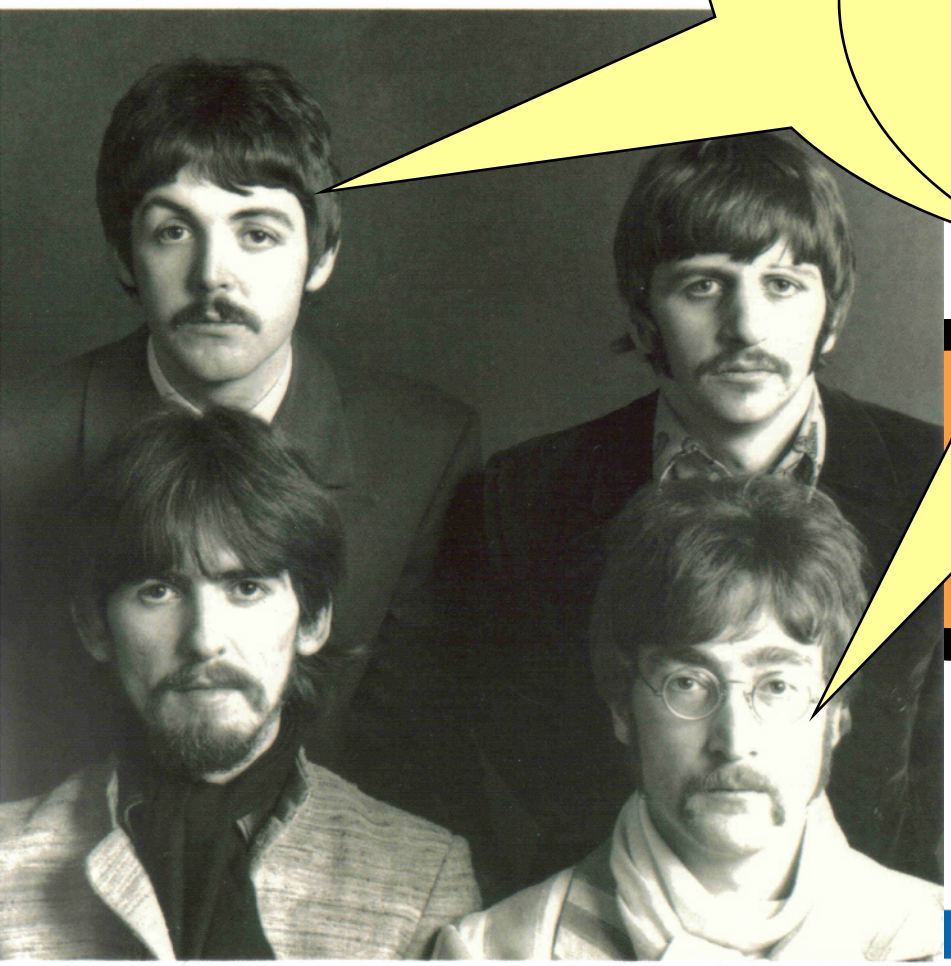
- Survey charting how Finnish universities have organised the depositing of digital research data, and to what extent the data are reused by the scientific community after the original research has been completed (2006-2007)
- Respondents: professors of human sciences, social sciences and behavioural sciences
- Views on the OECD guidelines and principles were also studied
- Response rate 28%

Research data – current situation in Finland

- Most existing data sets remain in the hands of original researchers
- A third in the department/unit
- Rarely any information on data sets in databases
- 10% of university departments have guidelines on preservation – 90% don't!

Proportion of reusable data





…Give
a

Sar

Help!
I need somebody,
Help, not just anybody,
Help, you know I need
someone, help!

ta?

CMOS
failure?

Barriers to reusing existing data in own field

• Insufficient documentation	54%
• Lack of informed consent	47%
• Confidentiality and data protection	43%
• Subject matter not relevant	43%
• IT problems (e.g. obsolete format)	38%
• Other legal problems	31%
• Ethical problems	23%

Barriers to open access in general

• Lack of informed consent	66%
• Workload for preparing data for archiving	53%
• Confidentiality issues	48%
• Concern regarding future (mis)use of data	46%
• Loss of competitive advantage	25%

http://www.fsd.uta.fi/english/informing_guidelines/index.html

Suomeksi | På svenska

FINNISH SOCIAL SCIENCE DATA ARCHIVE

Hae

» Refine search

DATA | ABOUT FSD | SITE CONTENTS | OTHER SERVICES | FAQ

main : other services : informing research participants

last updated 2008-02-29

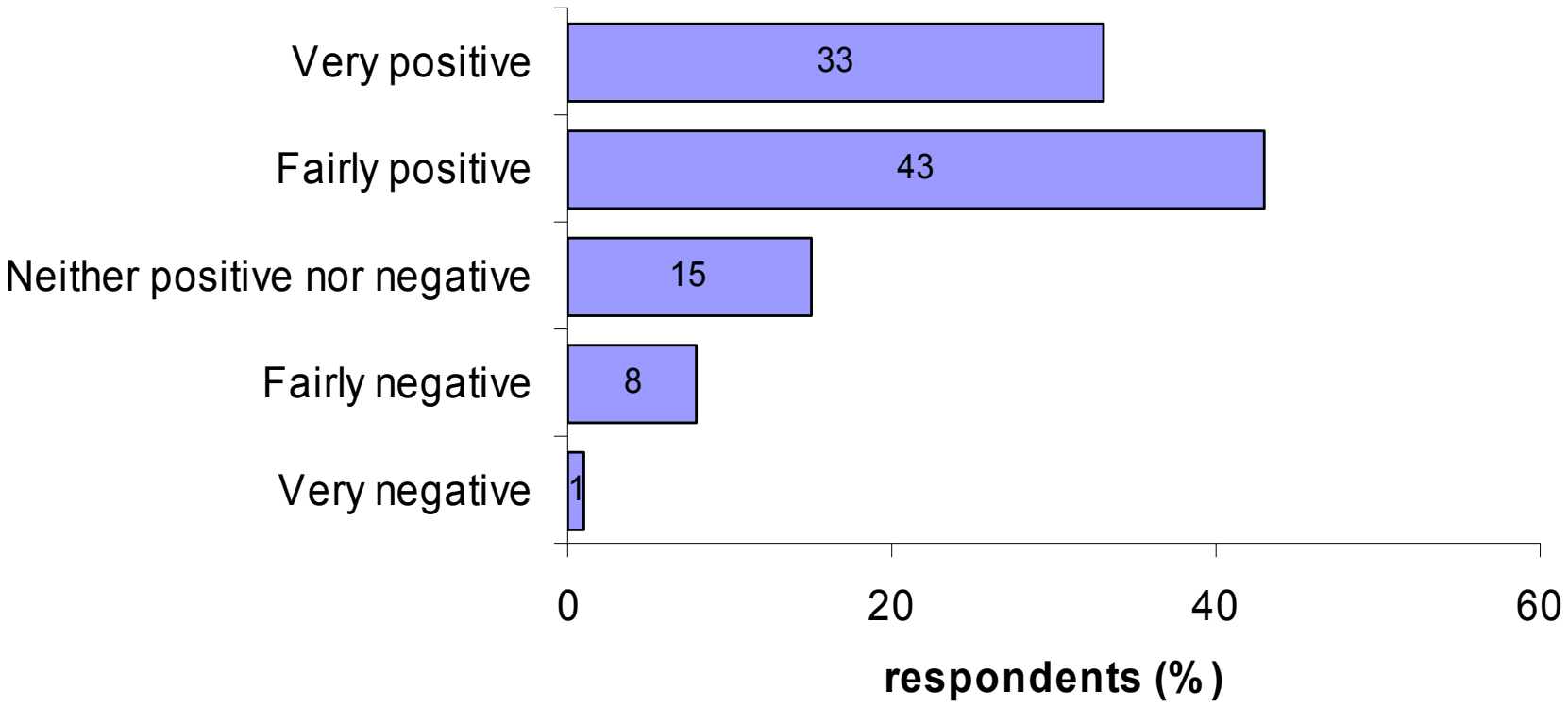
Informing Research Participants

Planning data collection | Informing research participants | Examples of informing potential participants | Sensitive information

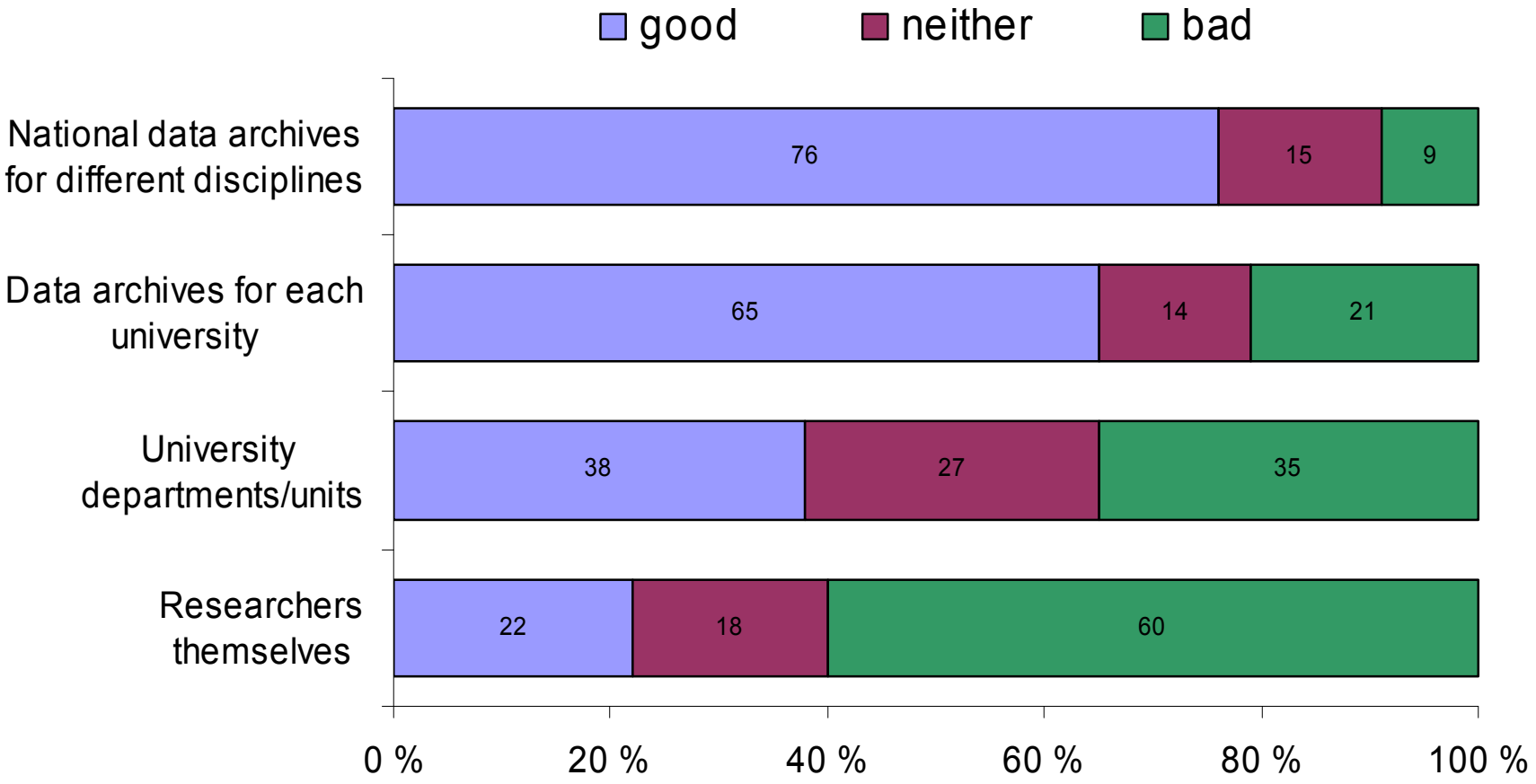
Research data may be collected in a number of ways, through survey questionnaires, interviews, written accounts or video recordings etc. In all cases, research participants must be informed of how the data will be used. Researchers are henceforth bound by the information given. If the data contain personal identifiers, information given to participants determines whether the data can be re-used later or whether the material must be destroyed as soon as the validity of the results has been validated.

This web page contains guidelines on how to inform research participants in a manner that at least researchers themselves will be able use the data in the future. Information given to participants should also allow researchers to archive the data, should they want to. The guidelines provided here refer to the situation in Finland, and may not be applicable in other countries due to differences in legislation.

Attitudes towards openness of own reseach data



Opinions on the ways to preserve research data



Role of funders essential

- Research funders in Finland do not have official data policy
- FSD has prepared a brochure that targets funders:
  - ”Ensure that mail surveys, interviews and video recordings funded by you get used more than once.”
  - ”The funder can recommend or require that there must be open access for research purposes to the primary data collected with its funding.”

www.fsd.uta.fi
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tutkimuksen
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Finnish Social Science Data Archive

Future of OA to data?

- Attitudes are becoming more favorable towards data OA
- 2008 National seminar on OA to primary data (as a consequence to our report)
- ERC Scientific Council Guidelines for Open Access (December 2007) was extented to primary data

Finnish Social Science Data Archive

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